only a very small proportion of total notes in circulation were demonetized in 1946.'[8]

In any event, Indira Gandhi did not undertake a demonetization. Various reports attribute this to the fact that the Wanchoo recommendations were publicly known, which may have 'resulted in black money operators getting rid of high-value currency notes.'[9] Geo-political factors such as the Bangladesh war and the delicate state of the economy at the time may also have weighed on Indira Gandhi's mind.

However, later that same year, the Jan Sangh, the precursor to the BJP, adopted demonetization in a resolution at a party conference in Jaipur. *The Times of India* reported: 'The resolution said between high prices and high taxes, the citizen was being "crushed".'

In 1977, the Janata Party, led by the Prime Minister Morarji Desai, came to power. The Jan Sangh was a part of the coalition, and, therefore, it was no surprise that demonetization was high on the agenda of the new government.

On 16 January 1978, the High Denomination Bank Notes (Demonetization) Act came into effect announcing that all high denomination notes (₹1,000, ₹5,000 and ₹10,000) would cease to be legal tender with effect from midnight that day. Thus the ₹1,000, ₹5,000 and ₹10,000 notes (which post the 1946 demonetization had been reintroduced in 1954), were now illegal for the second time.

These notes could be exchanged at designated offices of the RBI and notified branches of SBI and other banks until 19 January (effectively allowing only two days for exchange as 17 January was declared a bank holiday). A detailed declaration form had to be submitted in triplicate, along with the notes for exchange.

Like its previous avatar, this demonetization was also cloaked in secrecy! *The Reserve Bank of India's History, Volume III* details the sequence of events.

On 14 January, R. Janaki Raman, a senior official from the chief accountant's office in RBI, was asked to go to Delhi on 'some urgent